

Temperate pampas

With level plains as far as the eye can see, it's no wonder native South Americans named this region pampas—meaning “flat surface.” This temperate grassland provides plenty of seeds for birds, insects, and small mammals to eat.



Eyes high on its head allow the coypu to see when it swims.

Coypu

Sometimes mistaken for a beaver, the coypu is a water-loving rodent that can get up to 3 ft (1 m) long. Also called the “nutria,” it lives in riverside burrows and eats plants.

Argentine horned frog

At 5½ in (14 cm) long and weighing up to 1 lb (480 g), the horned frog is big enough to eat lizards, mice, and even other horned frogs.



SIERRAS DE CÓRDOBA

This lizard gets up to 4½ ft (1.4 m) long. During the day it hunts for snails, spiders, and insects.

Argentine black and white teju

This bloodsucking bug feeds on rodents, marsupials, and even humans. It sometimes passes on a parasite that causes disease.

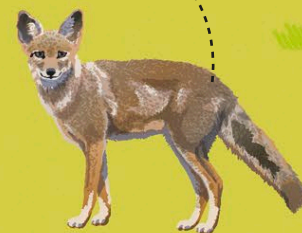
Assassin bug



Mollina's hog-nosed skunk

This skunk uses its broad, fleshy nose to snuffle out beetles and spiders to eat.

This medium-sized fox throws itself to the ground and plays dead if danger passes.



Pampas fox

ARGENTINA

With yellow, white, green, blue, red, and black feathers, this is one of the most colorful birds to live in the reedbeds of the pampas.



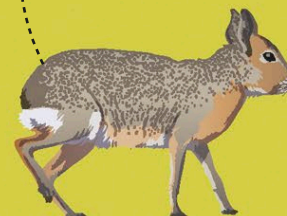
Many-colored rush-tyrant

The greater rhea can reach 4½ ft (1.4 m) tall. It can't fly, but it can run as fast as 37mph (60 kph).



Greater rhea

The long, powerful legs of this large rodent allow it to run up to 30mph (48 kph).



Patagonian mara

Colorado